FREE BOOK

My Body, My Words

A picture-and-word book that names every part of the body correctly and says what each part is for.

WHO IT IS FOR
Autistic children and young people, with the parents, carers, teachers and SNAs who support them.

NCCA STAGE
Primary · Junior Cycle

Easy read

Every body part has a name. The right name is clear and kind. I can learn the names. I can ask a trusted adult.

How to use this resource

- Read one page at a time, at a calm moment. There is no need to finish the book in one go.
- Use the **correct names** every time: penis, vulva, breasts, bottom. Clear names help children say what they mean, and tell if something is wrong.
- Cut out the matching cards at the back. Match each name to what the part does.
- Pages describe bodies in words and icons. Add real or drawn pictures from a health book your family chooses, if your child likes pictures.
- Agree the same words with school using the agreed words list in this series.

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Version 1.0 · my-body-my-words

Page 1: Everybody has a body

Your body is yours. It does many jobs every day. It helps you move, eat, think, feel and rest. Every body is different, and every body has parts with names.



My body belongs to me.



Every part has a name.



My body is okay just as it is.



I can use the real names.

Why we use the real names

- Real names are clear. Nobody has to guess what you mean.
- Real names help you tell a doctor, a parent or a teacher if something hurts.
- Real names are not rude. They are the correct words for a body.
- Real names help keep you safe, because you can say exactly what happened.

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Page 2: Parts you can see and share

These parts are on the outside. We can talk about them anywhere, with anyone.

Part	What it is	What it is for
Head	The top of your body. It holds your brain.	Your brain helps you think, remember, feel and move.
Eyes	Two round parts on your face.	They help you see. Blinking keeps them clean.
Ears	On both sides of your head.	They help you hear and keep your balance.
Nose	In the middle of your face.	It helps you smell and breathe.
Mouth, tongue and teeth	The opening at the bottom of your face.	They help you eat, drink, taste and talk.
Skin	The cover over your whole body.	It keeps germs out and helps you feel touch, hot and cold.
Hands and fingers	At the end of your arms.	They help you hold, write, touch and make things.
Legs and feet	Below your hips.	They help you stand, walk, run and jump.



My eyes help me see.



My hands help me hold things.



My legs help me walk.

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Page 3: Private parts

Some parts are **private**. Private parts are the parts that underwear covers. They are for you only. We talk about them in a private place, or with a trusted adult such as a parent, doctor or nurse.

Underwear covers private parts

A private part is a part of the body that is covered by underwear or a swimsuit. Breasts and nipples are also private.

Part	What it is	What it is for
Penis	Part of the body of boys and men, and some other people. It is on the outside, at the front.	Urine (wee) comes out of it. It is also part of making a baby when someone is an adult.
Testicles	Two small round parts in a skin bag called the scrotum, behind the penis.	They make sperm, from puberty onwards.
Scrotum	The soft skin bag that holds the testicles.	It holds the testicles and keeps them safe.
Vulva	The outside parts between the legs of girls and women, and some other people.	It covers and protects the openings inside.
Vagina	A passage inside the body, between the vulva and the womb.	Menstrual blood (a period) comes out through it. A baby can be born through it.
Clitoris	A small part at the top of the vulva.	It has lots of nerve endings, so it is very sensitive. It is a private part.
Womb (uterus)	A small stretchy space inside the body.	A baby can grow here when someone is an adult. Periods start here.
Breasts and nipples	On the chest. They grow at puberty in some bodies.	Breasts can make milk after a baby is born.
Bottom and anus	The bottom is at the back. The anus is the opening at the bottom.	Poo (faeces) comes out of the anus.
Urethra	A tiny tube. Urine comes out of the body through it.	It carries urine (wee) out of the body.

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Page 4: Inside my body

Most of your body is inside. You cannot see it, but it works all day and all night.



Heart

A muscle that pumps blood around your body.

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Lungs

They take in air so your body gets oxygen.

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Brain

It sends messages to every part of you.

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Stomach and intestines

They break down food and take out what your body needs.

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Bladder

It holds urine (wee) until you go to the toilet.

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Bones and muscles

Bones hold you up. Muscles help you move.

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My body gives me messages

Your body tells you what it needs. It can be hard to notice these messages. Practise noticing them.

The message	What my body might need
Tummy feels empty or rumbles	Food
Mouth is dry	A drink of water
Tummy feels full and pushing at the bottom	The toilet (a poo)
Feeling of needing to wee	The toilet (a wee)
Eyes feel heavy, yawning	Rest or sleep
Hot, sweaty or itchy	A cooler place, a drink, or a change of clothes
Pain or a feeling that something is wrong	Tell a trusted adult. They can help.

Page 5: Bodies are different

No two bodies are the same. Some bodies have a penis. Some bodies have a vulva. All bodies are different sizes and shapes and colours. Some bodies use a wheelchair or a hearing aid. Some bodies are autistic. Every body is a good body.

All bodies are different.

No body is better than another.

My body is mine.

Private words, private places

- We say the names of private parts when we need to, for example at the doctor, or when we wash.
- We do not touch other people's private parts. Other people do not touch ours.
- Washing, using the toilet, or a doctor's check-up are the only times someone else may need to help with private parts. Trusted adults tell you first.
- If anyone breaks these rules, say **no**, go away, and tell a trusted adult. Keep telling until someone listens.

Who is my trusted adult?

My trusted adults

At home: _____

At school: _____

Someone else: _____

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Page 6: Matching cards

Cut out the cards on the next pages. Put the **name cards** in one pile. Put the **job cards** in another. Match each name to its job.

Name cards: outside parts



Eyes

Name card

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Ears

Name card

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Nose

Name card

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Mouth

Name card

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Hands

Name card

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Feet

Name card

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Job cards: outside parts



I help you see

Which part am I?

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I help you hear

Which part am I?

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I help you smell and breathe

Which part am I?

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I help you eat, drink and talk

Which part am I?

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I help you hold and touch

Which part am I?

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I help you stand and walk

Which part am I?

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Name cards: private parts

Use these with a trusted adult, in a private place.



Penis

Name card

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Testicles

Name card

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Vulva

Name card

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Vagina

Name card

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Breasts

Name card

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Bottom and anus

Name card

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Job cards: private parts



Urine (wee) comes out of me. I am on the outside, at the front.

Which part am I?

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We make sperm from puberty. We are in a skin bag.

Which part am I?

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I cover and protect the openings between the legs.

Which part am I?

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A period comes out through me. I am a passage inside the body.

Which part am I?

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I can make milk after a baby is born.

Which part am I?

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Poo comes out of me.

Which part am I?

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Notes for adults: answering questions calmly

- Stay calm and matter of fact. Your tone teaches your child that bodies are normal and questions are welcome.
- Use the correct names every time. Avoid nicknames that may confuse, for example 'down there' or 'bits'.
- Answer the question that was asked, in short, literal sentences. If you do not know, say: **'Good question. I will find out and tell you.'** Then do.
- If a question comes at a public time, say: **'Good question. Let's talk about it in a private place.'** Then follow through at home.
- Repeat. Autistic children often learn by repeating. The same question many times is learning, not defiance.
- Tell your child who touches their body for health reasons (doctor, nurse), and that they say first what they will do.
- Check the words with your child's school so everyone uses the same names.

Curriculum links

NCCA and Department of Education alignment

- Primary SPHE (1999), strand **Myself**, strand unit *Taking care of my body*, and *Growing and changing*; Stay Safe programme (body ownership and safe/unsafe touch).
- Junior Cycle SPHE (2023), Strand 3 **Relationships and Sexuality** and Strand 1 **Understanding Myself and Others**: knowing the correct names and functions of body parts.
- NCCA guidance on RSE for students with special educational needs: use correct terms, visual supports and consistent language at home and school.

Universal Design for Learning

Every Autism & Me resource offers more than one way in: pictures and words together, an easy-read line, things to do with your hands, and scripts to practise. Keep the learning aim the same for everyone, and change the route. No diagnosis is needed to use any support in this resource.

Getting support in Ireland

Childline (ISPCC)

Free, 24 hours: phone 1800 66 66 66, text 50101, or chat at childline.ie. For anyone under 18.

Tusla – Child and Family Agency

Report a worry about a child's safety to your local Tusla social work duty team. Contacts at tusla.ie.

Parentline

Support for parents and carers: 01 873 3500, parentline.ie.

Your GP or public health nurse

For questions about puberty, periods, body changes or health checks.

Your school

Talk to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP) for child safeguarding, a class tutor or year head.

Autism & Me

Questions about this resource or training for your school: contactautismandme@gmail.com · autismandme.ie

If a child tells you something worrying

Stay calm. Listen, and believe them. Do not promise to keep it a secret. Write down what they said in their own words, with the date. Pass it on the same day: in a school, to the Designated Liaison Person (DLP); otherwise to Tusla. If anyone is in immediate danger, call 112 or 999. Follow *Children First: National Guidance for the Protection and Welfare of Children* (2017).

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